

Metasploit Framework — Practical Tool Guide

Search → Module → Options → Check → Run → Session, with service/version/CVE-based searching and the difference between Auxiliary and Exploit modules.

» Abdullah Nasser Almsan — Personal Pentest Reference

Usage note: For legal labs. Do not run an exploit simply because its name looks relevant; connect it to evidence from Nmap/enumeration and a matching version or CVE.

NMAP

Service / Version

SEARCH

Find a module

CHECK

Review options

SESSION

Prove the result

Contents

1. Starting Metasploit and organizing the lab
2. Module types
3. Search: how to search correctly
4. Choosing and reviewing a module
5. Auxiliary workflow
6. Exploit workflow
7. Sessions and jobs
8. Time-saving commands

1. Starting Metasploit and organizing the lab

Begin with a clean workspace before looking for a module.

KALI TERMINAL — Quiet console

```
msfconsole -q
```

MSFCONSOLE — Help

```
help
```

MSFCONSOLE — Database status

```
db_status
```

MSFCONSOLE — Separate workspace for the lab

```
workspace -a [LAB_NAME]
workspace
```

MSFCONSOLE — Import Nmap results directly

```
db_nmap -sV -sC -p[PORTS] [TARGET]
```

If the database is connected, the results appear in hosts/services.

2. Module types

Type	Meaning	When to use it
auxiliary	Scanning, enumeration, login checks, and similar actions without a traditional exploit payload	Start here to gather information or test a service.
exploit	A module targeting a specific vulnerability	Only after clear evidence: product/version/CVE/preconditions.
payload	The code/behavior that runs after a successful exploit	Choose a shell or Meterpreter payload compatible with the exploit.
post	Modules used after a session already exists	Post-exploitation information gathering/actions inside an authorized lab.

3. Search: how to search correctly

Search by service, product, version, or CVE - not only by port number.

MSFCONSOLE — General service search

```
search smb
```

MSFCONSOLE — Limit to Auxiliary

```
search type:auxiliary smb
```

MSFCONSOLE — Limit to Exploit

```
search type:exploit smb
```

MSFCONSOLE — Product/version search

```
search type:exploit apache 2.4.49
```

MSFCONSOLE — CVE or module name

```
search cve:2021-41773
search name:ms17_010
```

Note: Metasploit documents operators such as name/path/platform/type/app/author/cve/bid. Do not depend on search port:445 as the main method; when you only know a port, identify the service first with Nmap.

MSFCONSOLE — Filter imported services by port

```
services -p 445
```

This searches the services you discovered/imported, not the module catalog itself.

4. Choosing and reviewing a module

Do not jump from a search result directly to execution. Read the module information and required options first.

MSFCONSOLE — Read info and load the module

```
info [MODULE]  
use [MODULE]
```

MSFCONSOLE — Required options

```
show options  
show missing
```

MSFCONSOLE — Advanced options, targets, payloads

```
show advanced  
show targets  
show payloads
```

MSFCONSOLE — Leave module

```
back
```

5. Auxiliary workflow

Auxiliary modules are excellent for enumeration and validation before an exploit.

MSFCONSOLE — SSH version scanner example

```
use auxiliary/scanner/ssh/ssh_version  
set RHOSTS [TARGET]  
run
```

MSFCONSOLE — SMB shares example

```
use auxiliary/scanner/smb/smb_enumshares  
set RHOSTS [TARGET]  
run
```

MSFCONSOLE — Search for a login scanner

```
search type:auxiliary [SERVICE] login
```

Note: Login scanners can cause lockouts or noise. Use them only when credential testing is authorized by the lab.

6. Exploit workflow

Use a fixed sequence: Evidence → info/options → check → run.

MSFCONSOLE — Load exploit

```
use [EXPLOIT_MODULE]
```

MSFCONSOLE — Configure target and port

```
set RHOSTS [TARGET]
set RPORT [PORT]
show missing
```

MSFCONSOLE — Select payload when needed

```
show payloads
set PAYLOAD [PAYLOAD]
set LHOST [YOUR_REACHABLE_IP]
set LPORT [LISTEN_PORT]
```

MSFCONSOLE — Check if supported

```
check
```

Note: Not every module supports check, and a positive check is not a guarantee of success.

MSFCONSOLE — Run

```
run
```

RHOST/RHOSTS is the target. LHOST is your address reachable by the target for the callback.

7. Sessions and jobs

After gaining access, manage the session instead of re-running the exploit.

MSFCONSOLE — List and enter sessions

```
sessions
sessions -i [ID]
```

METERPRETER / SHELL — Background a session

```
background
```

MSFCONSOLE — List and stop jobs

```
jobs
jobs -k [JOB_ID]
```

8. Time-saving commands

MSFCONSOLE — Global options

```
setg RHOSTS [TARGET]
setg LHOST [YOUR_IP]
unsetg RHOSTS
```

MSFCONSOLE — Re-run the last module

```
rerun
```

Use rerun only in modules that support it; otherwise use run again as appropriate.

MSFCONSOLE — Save/run a resource script

```
makerc lab.rc
resource lab.rc
```

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

<https://docs.metasploit.com/docs/using-metasploit/basics/using-metasploit.html>

<https://docs.rapid7.com/metasploit/modules>

<https://docs.rapid7.com/metasploit/manual-exploitation/>